Release process

Production releases go out every Tuesday between 11:00 and 13:00. Any deployment outside that window must be approved by the release manager before it starts.

Every release needs a rollback plan written in the pull request. Releases are announced in the engineering channel at least one hour in advance.

Hotfixes for customer-facing bugs may skip the weekly window but still need a second reviewer.

Incident severity levels

Alerts are classified by severity. A severity-1 alert means customers cannot use the product at all; an incident commander is named and a status page update is published every 30 minutes until the issue is resolved.

A severity-2 alert means a major feature is degraded. Status page updates are published every 2 hours. Severity-3 alerts are handled during working hours.

After every severity-1 or severity-2 incident the team writes a blameless review within 5 working days.

Code review

Every change needs one approval from a teammate before it is merged. Changes to infrastructure code, billing or authentication need two approvals, one of them from a code owner.

Reviewers aim to respond within one working day. If a review has had no response for two days, ask in the team channel.

Large changes over 800 lines should be split into smaller pull requests.

Cloud cost control

Teams are responsible for their cloud bill. Any new cloud service that will cost more than 500 US dollars per month must be approved by the engineering lead before it is created.

Cost reports are sent on the first Monday of every month. Unused test environments are shut down automatically after 14 days.

Reserved capacity purchases are decided quarterly by the finance and platform teams together.

Service credentials and secrets

API keys and service credentials live in the secrets manager and are rotated every 180 days by the platform team. Never commit credentials to the repository.

Each service has its own credentials; sharing a key between two services is not allowed. Revoke a credential immediately if it appears in logs or a screenshot.

Access to production databases is granted for 8 hours at a time through the access request tool.

Learning and conferences

Engineers receive 5 paid days per year for training, courses and conferences. These days are in addition to normal annual leave and do not carry over.

The learning budget is Rs 40,000 per person per year. Choose a course or event, write two lines on why it helps your work and share it with your manager.

After a conference, give a short talk to the team within a month.

Engineering onboarding

New engineers get a buddy for the first 60 days. In week one you set up your laptop, get access to the code repository and ship a small change to production.

During the first month you shadow a teammate during their on-call week before joining the rotation yourself in month three.

Your manager holds a check-in with you every week for the first three months.

Internal error codes

Internal services report problems with short codes. I-4012 means the job queue is full and new jobs are being delayed. I-4013 means a worker lost its database connection.

I-5020 means a scheduled export failed and will be retried automatically. I-5021 means the retry limit was reached and a person must restart the export.

These codes appear in internal logs only. Customers see the public error codes documented in the product FAQ.